

The name for my proposed project is The Effects of Technology In Early Education. The motivation of the project is to determine if the technology being used in classrooms is helping/benefiting students. My github handle is adiaz218. My group mates are Nandini Jirobe: njiro2@uic.edu, nandinijirobe, Marianne Hernandez: mhern85@uic.edu, marhern19, Sonina Mut: smut3@uic.edu, snina22, and Yuting Lu: lyuti@uic.edu, yutinglu103.

The question we will be trying to answer is if having ipads or laptops in the classroom is beneficial to the students. Specifically those in elementary school. This problem was chosen because there are already studies that show how technology has negatively affected children in the development stages (if not used in moderation). I hypothesize that the usage of technology in the classroom is beneficial to students, if used properly, and helps to prepare students for the real world where our devices are constantly evolving and knowing how to work with technology is a necessity.

I'm sure there is data available on the topic, but also collecting my own data from elementary schools around Chicago would be beneficial since it would be more up to date and more controlled. Tracking students' performances in their classes as well as getting their teacher's first hand experience would be the most relevant details. Also finding a school that does not have technology in the classroom would be a very relevant detail so we could have a control group to compare the other schools to. I believe that the data can be collected within 2 or 3 months.

After collecting the data, looking for a positive trend between student's academic performances and the use of technology will show if schools should continue to use devices in the classroom or if they should go back to the way things were. Since the data will only be for schools in Chicago, the next steps would be to continue collecting data in schools in the state or across the country even. By the end, schools should be able to determine if having technology in the classroom should be continued. Graphs will be used to visualize every school's performance and technology usage, since multiple schools will be compared to each other, bar graphs will be the best way to present data. The system will be static and for the progress report, I hope to have the data and relevant information collected from multiple elementary schools in the Chicago area.